

Which of the following drugs has an effect on the central nervous system similar to that of alcohol?

- ✔ ☒ A. Benzodiazepines [87%]
☐ B. Hallucinogens [3%]
☐ C. Cocaine [3%]
☐ D. Amphetamines [6%]

Correct

87% answered correctly

Explanation:

Psychoactive (consciousness-altering) drugs		
Drug category	Examples	Effects
Stimulants	Amphetamines, cocaine	Speeds up CNS function, elevates mood
Depressants	Alcohol, barbiturates, benzodiazepines	Slows down CNS function
Narcotic analgesics ("painkillers")	Morphine, codeine, heroin	Lessens sensation of pain
Hallucinogens	Lysergic acid diethylamide (LSD)	Triggers mind-altering effects

Psychoactive drugs are drugs that have an effect on **mood, thinking, and/or behavior**. They may be classified in a number of ways, such as by chemical structure or the effect they have on the brain. Among the most common classifications are narcotics (usually opiates), depressants, stimulants, and hallucinogens.

Sedatives (eg, barbiturates, benzodiazepines) and alcohol belong to a category of drugs called **depressants** (or sedative hypnotics), which **slow down, inhibit, or depress** the central nervous system. These drugs are also known as anxiolytics as they **reduce anxiety**. Depressants exert their primary anxiolytic effect through binding at the GABA_A receptor, enhancing the effect of **GABA**, the principal **inhibitory** neurotransmitter in the nervous system.

(Choice B) Hallucinogens (eg, LSD) are not depressants; rather, they induce powerful mind-altering effects, including false sensory perceptions (hallucinations) and an altered sense of time.

(Choices C and D) Cocaine and amphetamines are stimulants, which increase feelings of well-being, energy, and alertness.

Educational objective:

Stimulants (eg, cocaine, amphetamines) increase feelings of well-being, energy, and alertness; depressants (eg, alcohol, benzodiazepines, barbiturates) slow down or inhibit the central nervous system and reduce anxiety; narcotics (generally opiates) are analgesics ("painkillers"); and hallucinogens have powerful mind-altering effects.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

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System:

Sensation, Perception, and Consciousness